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Hamas says it will free hostages tomorrow

GAZA STRIP

Hamas said it would free hostages tomorrow as scheduled, backing down from a threatened indefinite delay that had cast doubt on the durability of the initial six-week Gaza ceasefire.

Israel had responded by putting the military on high alert, and US President Donald Trump said his ally should "let hell break out" if Hamas made good on the threat. The US terror-designated organisation then recast the move as a warning.

After conferring with Qatari and Egyptian mediators, Hamas said yesterday it had reaffirmed its "commitment to implementing the agreement as signed, including the exchange of prisoners according to the scheduled timeline." At least three Israelis held by the Iran-backed group are due to be released in the next round of a phased exchange for hundreds of jailed Palestinians.

The group said mediators agreed to press Israel over the transportation into Gaza of prefabricated housing, tents, medical equipment and fuel for the war-ravaged population. However, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office pushed back.

— Bloomberg
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Dubai Loop project 'set to revolutionise transportation'

17KM UNDERGROUND MOBILITY SYSTEM IN COLLABORATION WITH MUSK'S FIRM

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The 12th World Governments Summit (WGS) concluded in Dubai yesterday with the announcement of Dubai Loop, a new underground transportation project in the emirate in collaboration with The Boring Company, owned by tech visionary and world's richest man Elon Musk. The project was announced during Musk's session at WGS where he said the Las Vegas-style tunnel system would be "like a wormhole." "It's going to be like a wormhole. You are just gonna wormhole from one part of the city...boom...and you're out in another spot of the city, and it's great," Musk said while addressing WGS virtually.

Cutting-edge solutions

A couple of hours later, Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, took to Musk's X to reveal more details about Dubai Loop which he said is "set to revolutionise transportation."

He said an MoU was signed between Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) and



Courtesy: Dubai Media Office

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE, and Ruler of Dubai, with Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs. Shaikh Mohammad expressed his gratitude to the heads of state, prime ministers, and delegates who participated in the World Governments Summit 2025.

The Boring Company under which "Dubai will explore the development of the 17-kilometre project." He also announced that there will be 11 stations for the tunnel which will have a capacity to transport more than 20,000 passengers per hour.

Shaikh Hamdan said "the project reflects Dubai's commitment to advancing new cutting-edge mobility solutions."

"Dubai's spirit of innovation thrives on strong partnerships with global industry leaders. Under the leadership of @HHShkMohd, the city continues to redefine the future of transportation, both above and below ground, setting new benchmarks for sustainability, efficiency, and urban connectivity," his post added.

Omar Sultan Al Olama, UAE Minister of State for Artificial In-

telligence, Digital Economy, and Remote Work Applications, and Vice Chair of WGS, who made the joint partnership announcement while in conversation with Musk, said the loop project is going to cover Dubai's most densely populated areas for people to go from point to point in a seamless manner. "We hope to change people's lives," he said.

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